

Why do people do what they do?



COM-B, after Michie, van Stralen & West.

For anyone to do something, three things need to be in place. They can, it's possible, and they want to. Use it on the people you're working with, or on your own team. Best done with a few people, so there's some healthy disagreement.

THREE STEPS

- 1 Name the behaviour at the top. Be specific: who does what, where and when.
- 2 Put each thing that helps or gets in the way in its box, one sticky note each. Fill all three before looking for a fix.
- 3 Circle where the biggest gap is. That's where to start.

FOR EXAMPLE

A sports club. The behaviour: teens turn up to Tuesday training.

CAN THEY?	"Some didn't know training had moved to Tuesdays." <i>capability: mind</i>
IS IT POSSIBLE?	"Training's at 4pm, and the bus doesn't come till 5." <i>opportunity: things around them</i> "Their mates have stopped coming." <i>opportunity: people around them</i>
DO THEY WANT TO?	"They're wiped out after school." <i>motivation: without thinking</i>

The club had assumed the teens just didn't want to. The bus timetable turned out to be the biggest gap.

THEN TALK ABOUT IT

Where did we see ourselves?

Talk about which of these felt familiar from your own team, and how it felt to name them. Those feelings are signs too.

GOING FURTHER

Use it more than once. At the start, turn it on your own team: what will this work ask of us? When the work slows or stops, ask which part is missing. At the end, what helped, and what got in the way?

Watch for blaming motivation. "They don't care" is often a missing skill or chance in disguise.

THE BEHAVIOUR WE'RE LOOKING AT

